



An 802.11g Linksys wireless broadband router

nect existing Wi-Fi LANs to the Internet by offering shared theoretical throughput rates of 70 Mbps over a range of up to 50 km. WiMAX is touted as the answer to cheap broadband access across the world, especially in rural areas. Because of its long range, the costs of expensive cabling will be negated, and so connecting even the remotest of villages will become possible.

All these standards and more come under the wide umbrella of ‘Wireless’; however, we will only concern ourselves here with the IEEE 802.11a, 802.11b and 802.11g standards when referring to Wi-Fi—because these are the most cost-effective and accepted standards. Also, this book only attempts to help you bring wireless into your personal life, and not to plan wireless solutions for towns, cities or nations.

On the personal or home front, there are a few more technologies that deserve mention when talking about home networking.

1.3 Bluetooth, HPNA and HomePlug

Bluetooth

Bluetooth supposedly got its name from the Danish King Harald Blåtand, which translates to ‘Harold Bluetooth’ in English. It is a